



Before You Go

Applying for housing at Red Deer Housing Authority — what to bring, what to write down, and what to ask for on your way out

Applications are taken in person, and the counter is open two mornings a week. If you arrive missing one document, you are sent away until the next opening. That can cost a fortnight. This page exists so that does not happen to you.

Where and when

Red Deer Housing Authority, Unit 2, 7429 – 50th Avenue, Red Deer.

Wednesdays and Thursdays only, 9:00 to 11:30 and 1:00 to 3:30.

403-343-2177. Their website is **bridgescl.ca** — as of 14 September 2026 the older rdha.ab.ca address returns a security warning and reddeerhousingauthority.ca has lapsed to gambling content. Ring first and ask two things: whether those hours still hold, and whether you can be sent the forms to fill in at home before you come. Filling them in at a counter while in pain is nobody's best work.

If getting there is the barrier, say so on the phone and ask what they can do. Ask for the answer in writing.

What to bring

The first four are needed because of what the Housing Authority publishes about eligibility. The rest are commonly asked for. Bring them anyway — carrying a document you did not need costs you nothing, and going home for it costs you a week.

■	Photo identification, for every adult in the household	Identity, and household size.
■	Your AISH or ADAP statement	Income is one of the three things you are scored on. Rent is set at 30 per cent of gross income.
■	Proof of any other income — CPP, CPP-D, work, support payments	They will ask about all of it. Leaving something out and having it found later is worse than declaring it.
■	Proof of assets — bank statements	Assets must be under \$25,000, not counting household furnishings. This is a published rule.
■	Something showing three months in the area	You must have lived or worked in the area for the past three months. A lease, a bill, or a letter works.
■	Your addresses going back three years	Commonly asked on social housing applications. Write the list before you go rather than trying to remember at the desk.
■	Your written statement of accessibility need	See the next section. This is the one people arrive without, and it is the one that matters most.

The part nobody tells you

Until 2022, the provincial scoring had its own lines for degree of accessibility and for accommodation that was harmful to health. Both were repealed. There is no longer a box on the form that captures disability on its own.

What remains are broader headings, including health and safety risk, scored on the evidence you provide. Read that last part again. **On the evidence you provide.** Nobody goes looking for it. If your need is explained out loud at a counter and written nowhere, it may score nothing at all.

So bring it written down. One page, signed and dated, attached to the application. Something like this:

A written statement of need — say it plainly, in your own words

My condition affects my mobility. I cannot manage stairs. I need a ground-floor unit or one served by a lift.

My current housing is unsafe for me because [the stairs / the bathroom I cannot get into / the area].

I have home care support and my care needs are documented with Alberta Health Services.

I am asking that this be recorded as a health and safety risk in my assessment.

Attach anything you already have from a doctor, a specialist, or an occupational therapist. If you have had a continuing care assessment through Health Link 811, mention it by date.

Before you leave the counter

Four things, every time. They take two minutes and they are what you will rely on in three months when nobody remembers the conversation.

- **Ask for written confirmation that your application was received**, with the date. If they will not give you a letter, ask for the name of the person who took it and write it down yourself.
- **Ask for a stamped or photocopied set of everything you handed over**. Files go missing. A stamped copy is the difference between proving you applied and starting again.
- **Ask what your application was scored on** and whether the accessibility need was recorded.
- **Ask how you will be contacted, and what happens if they cannot reach you**. Some lists remove people who do not reply to a letter.

If you are offered somewhere you cannot live safely

You are allowed to say no. A unit you cannot get into, or cannot be safe in, is not housing.

But know what a second refusal costs. As of 14 September 2026, Civida in Edmonton publishes that an applicant who refuses twice *without reasonable cause* has their application **cancelled** and may reapply **six months later**. Other bodies do not publish their policy at all. So the reason is the whole thing.

Put the refusal in writing the same day, with the reason — the stairs, the bathroom, the area. Not over the phone.

Ask them to confirm in writing that it is recorded as a refusal for **reasonable cause** and that your position on the list is unaffected.

Ask for a copy of their policy on refused offers, and ask what happens on a second refusal. Most bodies do not publish it, so asking is the only way to know where you stand.

Keep the reply. That message is your protection.

Do not stop at one list

These are separate systems and you can be in all of them at once. Waiting on one before starting the next is the most common way people lose a year.

- **Health Link, 811** — continuing care needs assessment. No referral, no cost. Opens the care options and produces documentation that strengthens this application.
- **Rent Assistance Benefit** — helps with rent in a private rental. People on AISH and ADAP are eligible. Apply through the Housing Authority or Alberta Supports, 1-877-644-9992.
- **Bridges Community Living** and **Piper Creek Foundation** — separate applications, separate lists.
- **RAMP** — up to \$12,000 a year to modify a home you are already in. Renters qualify with landlord consent.
- **Cosmos Community Support Services, 403-343-0715** — will help you work through any of this. You do not have to do it alone.

Bring more paper than you think you need. Ask for a copy of everything you hand over.

Write down who you spoke to and when. None of this is suspicion — it is simply how you keep your own record.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown
albertadisabilitybreakdown@outlook.com

Companion to *Finding Accessible Housing in Red Deer*. Compiled September 2026. Eligibility conditions as published by Red Deer Housing Authority; scoring

categories from Alberta's Social Housing Accommodation Regulation. Confirm hours and document requirements by phone before travelling.